Cup in 2015, and invariably revolved around the concept of 'Protea fire', which had become so important to all of us.

It had started as Graeme Smith's idea. He had some years before identified the need for the national cricket team to develop its own clear culture and identity, and he wanted to create something around the fighting spirit that, like me, he valued above anything else. In his mind, he wanted the Proteas to be first and foremost a team that is prepared to bleed for each other, one that never gives up, that always fights back from adversity.

The eureka moment came when he discovered that the protea, the national flower after which we were named, embodies all of these precious qualities. When the South African veld has been destroyed by fire, it is the protea that is resilient and grows among the ashes, that fights back and blooms again.

I remember him calling me when I was in Bangalore, and explaining the idea.

'Can you write a song about it?' he asked.

'How do you mean?'

'We need to create a song about Protea fire, which the team can sing.'

I sat on the balcony of my hotel room in India, and wrote a song with a chorus in isiXhosa, translated as 'Forever we'll keep the fire burning'.

Umlilo uhlala uyatshisa
Umlilo uhlala uyatshisa ye
Umlilo uhlala uyatshisa.

Within the Proteas squad, we attach great importance to building on the achievements of the past, honouring and respecting every single person who has played for South Africa, and I included some words in the second verse to reflect this concept of picking up a torch from the great names of the past, and carrying it forward and then handing it on: